AN OSINT STYLE GUIDE

Citation, Sourcing, & Analytic Standards

Version 1.5 (October 2026)

About This Version

This style guide governs citation, source, and analytical language for whitepapers, scripts, newsletter postings, and any other research project published under this brand. It is a working document, meaning there are gaps in this document's coverage. Where this document is silent, use your best judgment, be consistent within the piece, and send a note so the gap(s) can be closed in the next revision cycle.

Version 1.5 brings this guide into line with the OSINT Citation Generator and expands the Source Description Library from 188 descriptions to 771. Nothing in it requires redoing citations already published. Use the new forms from now on.

Corrections in v1.5:

Element 8 is now called Locator. Its old name, Location Information, was easily confused with element 3, Location.

Part numbers are dropped from section headings, Notes are numbered in sequence, and the three appendices the text refers to (Abbreviations, the Source Description Library, and Expanded Footnote Examples) are restored.

EX-06 named four authors. Rule 1(e) names the first three, then et al.

EX-09 credited the National Security Strategy to the US Department of Defense. The White House issues it.

EX-23 and EX-24 gave the Kofman and Lee article the wrong year and a shortened link that does not resolve. Both now give 02 June 2022 and the full URL.

EX-03 now italicizes *The New York Times*, and EX-11 credits the volume's editor, as EX-04 does.

EX-70 repeated its location in the publisher slot, and EX-71 and EX-82 did not credit unsigned work to the outlet plus Staff. All three now follow elements 5 and 1(g).

EX-45 called the NATO 2022 Strategic Concept the NATO 2030 Strategic Concept, and EX-87 put a written description in quotation marks, which rule 2(c) sets plain.

Descriptions in element 4, EX-06, EX-09, and 19 examples in Appendix C now use terms from the Source Description Library. EX-35 and EX-43 keep plain descriptions, which the guide allows.

Additions Made to v1.5:

- A Source Description Library of 771 descriptions in 16 categories (Appendix B), with notes that tell similar descriptions apart.
- A fixed order for everything inside the description bracket, and three kinds of entry that can go in it: qualifiers about the copy you cite, access notes such as *paywalled*, and language notes.
- *Journal Article*, which carries a review-status qualifier when a journal is not known to be peer-reviewed.
- Decision rules for *Monograph* and *Trade Book*, and for the title of a social media post.

- A rule for published English translations: credit the translator, and add *translated from* and the original language to the bracket.
- A chapter's containing volume may run past the ten-word limit on locations.
- Two pre-publication checklist items, on review status and on access.
- A pointer to the OSINT Citation Generator and its instructions for AI assistants.

The OSINT Citation Generator, https://gmichaelrapp.github.io/OSINT_Cites/, builds footnotes in this form and checks them against this guide. Its instructions for AI assistants, https://gmichaelrapp.github.io/OSINT_Cites/osint-citation-spec.md, let an assistant cite the same way.

Version 1.4 makes three (3) kinds of changes: it corrects errors found in v1.2 and v1.3, it closes gaps that came up in practice, and it adds house-style guidance that wasn't codified in previous editions of this style guide.

Corrections to v1.2 and v1.3:

The two axes of the source-rating matrix were labeled backward. Letters (A–F) rate the reliability of the source; numbers (1–6) rate the credibility of the information. The definitions were correct; only the axis labels were reversed. Existing ratings do not need to be redone.

F6 was listed as "Do Not Use" in one table and "Use with caution" in another. Resolved: F6 may be used, but never as sole support for a judgment.

D4 was placed in the Orange Zone but marked "Avoid" in the code table. Resolved in favor of Orange Zone treatment.

Reliability grade D changed from "Not Reliable" to "Not Usually Reliable," so that D and E are distinct.

The source-type table now describes typical starting points for a reliability grade rather than assigning grades by category. Grades are assigned by the analyst, on the record, not by the kind of institution involved.

Several examples contradicted the rules they illustrated: missing p./pp., a comma where the parenthetical requires a colon, an initials-only author list, a dropped quotation mark. Corrected throughout.

Worked examples are now labeled EX-01, EX-02, and so on, so that example numbers are never confused with live footnote numbers.

Additions Made to v1.4:

- A one-page Quick Reference, issued as a separate sheet.
- Rules for archiving and link rot, access dates, and volatile sources.
- Rules for translated and non-English sources.
- Rules for AI-generated content, satellite and geospatial imagery, and deleted, edited, or screenshotted posts.
- An estimative language table, so that the requirement to express uncertainty has vocabulary attached to it.
- A House Style section covering names, numbers, dates, acronyms, units, and contested place names.
- A corrections and versioning policy.
- A pre-publication checklist.

Contents

About This Version 2

Citation Basics 7

Common Citation Examples 11

BOOK 11

ARTICLE — Journal, Magazine, Newsletter, Newspaper 11

CHAPTER or SECTION in an EDITED VOLUME 11

WEBSITE 11

SOCIAL MEDIA POST OR INTERNET MEDIA 12

GOVERNMENT DOCUMENT 12

PRIMARY SOURCE OR HISTORICAL DOCUMENT 12

Types of Notes 12

I — Specific Bibliographic Reference 12

II — General Bibliographic Reference 13

III — Secondary Citation 13

IV — Literature Overview 13

V — Commentary 14

VI — Subsequent Citations 14

Anchoring 14

Special Cases *14*

Volatile Sources, Archiving, and Link Rot 15

Archive before you cite 15

Access dates 15

Deleted, Edited, and Screenshotted Content 15

Non-English and Translated Sources 16

Satellite, Aerial, and Geospatial Imagery 16

AI-Generated Content 17

Multiple Sources in One Footnote 17

Source Reliability & Credibility *18*

The Matrix 18

Reliability of the Source (A–F) 18

Credibility of the Information (1–6) 19

Zones and Required Handling 19

Where Sources Typically Start 19

Rated Examples 20

Analytic Standards and Estimative Language *20*

The Standards 20

Estimative Language 21

Confidence Is Not Probability 21

Assumptions and Intelligence Gaps 22

House Style *22*

Dates, Times, and Numbers 22

Names, Ranks, and Acronyms 22

Place Names and Contested Terminology 23

Quotation and Attribution 23

Formatting 23

Corrections, Versioning, and Checklist *24*

Corrections Policy 24

Versioning of Living Documents 24

Pre-Publication Checklist **24**

Appendix A — Abbreviations ***25***

Appendix B — Source Description Library ***26***

Government and Legal **26**

International Organizations and Diplomacy **26**

Academic and Research **27**

Reference, Data, and Statistics **27**

Think Tank, Industry, and Finance **28**

News and Media **28**

Social, Web, and User-Generated **29**

Imagery, Geospatial, and Tracking **29**

Military and Defense **30**

Cyber and Technical **30**

Science, Health, and Environment **31**

NGO, Humanitarian, and Civil Society **31**

Archival and Primary Sources **31**

Interviews, Communications, and Author's Own Work **31**

Literary, Artistic, and Creative Works **32**

Education, Institutional, and General **32**

Qualifiers **32**

Access Notes **33**

Telling Similar Descriptions Apart **33**

Appendix C — Expanded Footnote Examples ***34***

National Government **34**

International Organizations **35**

Academic **36**

Think Tanks **37**

News and Media **37**

Social and User-Generated **38**

Citation Basics

This style guide uses a full footnote system. No additional bibliography is required to be placed at the end of a whitepaper, script, or newsletter posting. Footnotes carry the full bibliographic reference, and they may also carry additional commentary. This makes the analysis transparent and the research replicable. Our readers should be able to find every source you used and see how you weighted it, as the writer-researcher. In some contexts, endnotes are acceptable where the format calls for them. Formatting for endnotes is identical to footnotes.

The Citation Pattern

Every footnote (or endnote) is built from the same eight (8) slots. Short works require quotations; larger works must be italicized. In some contexts, italics can be replaced with clear underlining.

Author, "Title," *Location* [Description] (Publisher: Date) URL/DOI: Locator.
Author, *Title*, *Location* [Description] (Publisher: Date) URL/DOI: Locator.

Note I: Not every slot applies to every source you'll cite. Slots that do not apply for a given source should be omitted, as should the punctuation that goes with them. Never leave an empty parenthetical or stray comma in your citation. The rules for dropped elements are given under each element that is explored below.

Note II: Footnotes, or endnotes, are numbered sequentially for each piece. Anchor them at the end of a paragraph or after a quotation rather than for every sentence. One well-built footnote (or endnote) carrying three (3) sources is better than a flurry of footnotes carrying only one.

Eight Elements for a Successful Citation

1. **Author**
    a. First name then surname: Marcus L'Amour, Andrew Erickson.
    b. For names conventionally written surname-first — Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Hungarian, and others — keep the person's own conventional order and do not invert it. Write Xi Jinping, not Jinping Xi. If a source itself uses Western order for the same person, follow the person, not the source.
    c. For transliterated names, use the form the person uses in English, where one exists; otherwise, use the guide's standard transliteration. Give a variant spelling in the description bracket if a reader would otherwise fail to find the source.
    d. Two or three authors: standard list formatting
        i. John Smith, Kelly Greene, and Simon Chavez.
    e. Four or more authors: name the first three, then et al.

   f. Editors, translators, and contributors follow the author list, separated by a semicolon, with (ed.), (trans.), or (contr.) after each name. List editors first, then translators, then contributors: Michael O'Henry, Chase Engel, and Sue Villanova; William Johnson-Cooke (ed.) and Ana Ruiz (trans.).
   g. No named author: use the organization (US Department of Defense, Congressional Research Service, Anthropic, Alphabet). Where an outlet publishes staff-written work without bylines, use the outlet followed by "Staff."
   h. No author and no organization: begin with the title, formatted as it would be in the title slot.
2. **Title**
   a. Short works — articles, posts, chapters, individual pages, videos — take "quotation marks."
   b. Larger works — books, reports issued as standalone documents, datasets, periodicals cited whole — are italicized.
   c. No title: write a description of the source in this slot instead, unquoted and unitalicized.
   d. Preserve the source's own capitalization and punctuation. If the title contains an error, reproduce it and follow with [sic].
   e. Social media posts have no headline, so the post's own words serve as its title, exactly as written, keeping its spelling, capitals, and hashtags. A short post is given whole. A longer one is cut after about a dozen words and ends with an ellipsis: "BREAKING: Multiple explosions reported near the port tonight, air defense active over…" A post with no text, such as an image or a video alone, takes a description under rule (c).
   f. A title not in English keeps its original form, followed by an English translation in square brackets. See Non-English and Translated Sources.
3. **Location**
   a. Where the source lives: the publication, platform, site, series, or archive that contains it. Should be italicized (or underlined if italicization isn't possible). Ten words or fewer.
      i. *YouTube · X · Telegram · Journal of Russian Economics · White House Government Website · Political Economy of Modern China Series by Routledge*
      ii. For a chapter or section, the location is the containing volume. Its title may run past ten words; never shorten a title to fit.
      iii. Do not repeat the title here. If the title and location would be identical, keep the title and drop the location.
4. **Description [in Square Brackets]**
   a. This is the element that distinguishes this guide from a general-purpose style. It tells the reader what kind of thing they are looking at before they click. Ten words or fewer. Use semicolons to separate items.

i. Basic type: [Peer-Reviewed Article] · [Whitepaper] · [Memo; leaked] · [Declassified Document]
ii. Report or document numbers: [CRS Report; Report #R12345]
iii. Volume and issue: [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 05, No. 02]
iv. Episodes: [Podcast; Eps. 225]
v. Archival detail: [Archival Material; Primary Source; Record Group 46; Records of the US Senate, 1789–1990]
vi. Source rating, where used: [Defense Analysis Article; B2]
vii. Anything a reader needs to judge the source before reading it: original language, resolution and capture date for imagery, and whether a transcript is on file.

b. Appendix B lists 771 descriptions in 16 categories, with the qualifier vocabulary and notes that tell similar descriptions apart. Pick the most specific description that fits. If nothing there fits, write a plain description and send a note so it can be added.
c. Items inside the bracket always run in this order, separated by semicolons: kind of source; details; qualifiers; language; access; rating.
    i. [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 38, No. 2; accepted manuscript; original in Chinese; institutional access; B2]
d. Qualifiers describe the copy of the source you are citing, not its kind: [Field Manual; leaked; scan] · [Speech; transcript]. Use only those a reader needs to weigh the source. The full vocabulary is in Appendix B.
e. Access notes say what stands between the reader and the source: paywalled, metered paywall, free registration required, institutional access, region-restricted, or app only. Say anything else in a few plain words. A source that is free to read takes no note. Where a free version exists, such as a preprint or an official release, cite it instead or alongside.
f. Language notes mark a source not in English: original in Russian, translation by author, machine translation, or, for a published English translation, translated from Russian. See Non-English and Translated Sources.
g. Journal articles: use Peer-Reviewed Article only when the journal is known to send its articles to outside referees. The journal's own statement, usually under About or For Authors, settles it. Otherwise use Journal Article with the review status as a qualifier: editor-reviewed, student-edited, not peer-reviewed, or, where it cannot be established, review status unclear. Never leave Journal Article without one: [Journal Article; Vol. 12, No. 3; student-edited].
h. Books: see Note III for choosing between Monograph and Trade Book.

5. **Publisher**
    a. Who issued the source: W. W. Norton, US Department of Defense, Congressional Research Service, RAND.

   b. *Drop the publisher* when it would simply repeat the location — most peer-reviewed journals, magazines, newspapers, and wire services. When the publisher is omitted, the parenthetical includes only the date: (2024), (03 March 2026).
   c. Keep the publisher when it differs meaningfully from the location: a book publisher, a government body publishing on a departmental site, a channel or account name distinct from the platform.
   d. For social video and social posts, the publisher slot holds the channel or account: (CappyArmy: 17 March 2026).
6. **Date**
   a. News, social media, internet video, press releases, and anything else where the day matters: DD Month YYYY—08 March 2026. Spell months out in full.
   b. Books, peer-reviewed articles, and chapters in edited works: year alone—2025.
   c. No date: n.d. Where a plausible date can be established from the source, give it as [ca. 2019] in the description bracket and say how you established it.
   d. Publisher and date share a single parenthetical, separated by a colon: (RAND: 2015). Where the publisher is dropped, the colon goes with it: (2015).
7. **URL or DOI**
   a. Give the full URL or DOI. Never shorten and never use a link shortener.
   b. DOIs take the resolvable form: https://doi.org/10.1234/example.5678
   c. Link to the most stable version available: a publisher's DOI landing page over a PDF mirror, a permalink over a feed URL.
   d. Volatile sources additionally require an archive link.
8. **Locator**
   a. p. for a single page; pp. for a range: p. 13, pp. 25–27. Use en (–) dashes in ranges.
   b. Chapters in edited volumes and reference works occupy the full page range of the chapter.
   c. Paraphrases, section-specific summaries, and quotations always take a specific page or range where pages exist. A footnote summarizing a source's overall argument may omit it.
   d. Never count paragraphs. Where no pages exist, cite the document's own structure: Osteoarthritis Section, CMC Reorganization Section, Article 4(2).
   e. Audio and video capture timestamps in the source's own clock format.
      i. See 30:15–32:40 for a discussion of airframe design.
   f. Locators follow a colon at the end of a full citation. In a subsequent short-form citation, the locator follows a comma instead — see Types of Notes, VI.

Common Citation Examples

Each example below is preceded by the pattern it follows. Example numbers (EX-01, EX-02) are labels only. They are not footnote numbers.

BOOK

Author, *Title*, *Location* [Description] (Publisher: Date) URL/DOI: pages.

EX-01 Michael Beckley, *Unrivaled: Why America Will Remain the World's Sole Superpower* [Monograph] (Cornell University Press: 2018): pp. 25–27.

Note III: *Monograph* means a scholarly book advancing a single sustained argument for specialists, usually from a university or academic press, with notes and a bibliography. *Trade Book* means a book published for a general readership, usually by a commercial house, even when a scholar wrote it. Look at the press and the back matter. When you cannot tell, use *Trade Book*.

ARTICLE — Journal, Magazine, Newsletter, Newspaper

Author, "Title," *Location* [Description] (Date) URL/DOI: pages.

EX-02 Tina Mukherjee, "Agroterrorism: A Less Discussed Yet Potential Threat to Agronomy," *Science and Culture* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 87, Nos. 3–4] (2021): pp. 120–122.

EX-03 David Sanger, "U.S. Expands Cyber Operations," *The New York Times* [News Article; B2] (12 February 2026) https://www.nytimes.com/2026/02/12/us/politics/cyber-operations.html.

CHAPTER or SECTION in an EDITED VOLUME

Author, "Title," *Containing Volume* [Description] (Publisher: Date) URL/DOI: pages.

EX-04 Michael S. Chase, Jeffrey Engstrom, Tai Ming Cheung, et al.; Geoffrey Park (ed.), "People's Liberation Army Modernization: Mid-1990s to 2025," *China's Incomplete Military Transformation: Assessing the Weaknesses of the People's Liberation Army (PLA)* [Long-Form Publication by Think Tank] (RAND: 2015): p. 13.

EX-05 Thomas Julian, Jeffery Ganyo, Edison Lewis, et al.; J. Louis Spencer (ed.), *Cybersecurity Handbook* [Edited Volume] (MIT Press: 2022): pp. 55–70.

WEBSITE

Author, "Title," *Location* [Description] (Publisher: Date) URL.

EX-06 Brian Hart, Bonny Lin, Maria Snegovaya, et al., "CRINK in 10 Charts," *CSIS* [Policy Analysis; B2] (24 November 2025) https://www.csis.org/analysis/crink-10-charts.

SOCIAL MEDIA POST OR INTERNET MEDIA

Author, "Title," *Platform* [Description] (Channel or Account: Date) URL.

EX-07 Chris Cappy, "Special Forces X76 'Jet Helicopter' Needs to Chill Out," *YouTube* [Video; C3] (CappyArmy: 17 March 2026) https://youtu.be/RSzdK_viw1Y: See 30:15–32:40 for discussion of airframe design.

EX-08 OSINTdefender, "Ukrainian Drone Strike Footage Near Bakhmut," *X* [Social Media Post; C3] (14 February 2026) https://x.com/sentdefender/status/1234567890. Archived: https://archive.ph/abc123 (captured 14 February 2026).

GOVERNMENT DOCUMENT

Author, *Title*, *Location* [Description] (Publisher: Date) URL.

EX-09 The White House, *National Security Strategy of the United States of America*, *White House Government Website* [National Strategy Document; A1] (US Government: November 2025) https://www.whitehouse.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/2025-National-Security-Strategy.pdf.

PRIMARY SOURCE OR HISTORICAL DOCUMENT

Author, "Title," *Archive* [Description] (Date) URL.

EX-10 James Monroe, "Message of President James Monroe at the Commencement of the First Session of the 18th Congress (The Monroe Doctrine)," *US National Archives Website* [Archival Material; Primary Source; Record Group 46; Records of the US Senate, 1789–1990] (02 December 1823) https://www.archives.gov/milestone-documents/monroe-doctrine.

Types of Notes

Six types are available. They can be combined — a literature overview footnote may end with commentary, and a specific reference may carry a caveat about the source's reliability.

I — Specific Bibliographic Reference

Cites a specific page, range, section, or timestamp. Attach to paraphrases, section-specific summaries, and quotations.

EX-11 Michael S. Chase, Jeffrey Engstrom, Tai Ming Cheung, et al.; Geoffrey Park (ed.), "People's Liberation Army Modernization: Mid-1990s to 2025," *China's Incomplete Military Transformation: Assessing the Weaknesses of the People's Liberation Army (PLA)* [Long-Form Publication by Think Tank] (RAND: 2015): p. 13.

II — General Bibliographic Reference

Points to a source as a whole, usually to support a broad claim or to direct the reader onward. Often opens with "See" or a framing clause.

EX-12 See Marek Dabrowski, "Thirty Years of Economic Transition in the Former Soviet Union: Macroeconomic Dimension," *Russian Journal of Economics* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 08, No. 02] (2022): pp. 95–121.

EX-13 An excellent introduction to Ukraine's unconventional approach to drone warfare can be found in Illya Sekirin; Andrew Simms (ed.), *Rise of the Machines: Drone Warfare in the Russia-Ukraine War: Tactics, Operations, Strategy* [Trade Book] (Helicon & Company: 2026).

III — Secondary Citation

Used when the original source could not be obtained, and you are relying on someone else's reproduction of it. Open with "Cited in" or "Quoted in," as context requires.

EX-14 Quoted in Armin Krishnan, "Fifth Generation Warfare, Hybrid Warfare, and Gray Zone Conflict: A Comparison," *Journal of Strategic Security* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 15, No. 4] (2022): p. 17.

Note IV: A secondary citation inherits the weaker of the two sources' ratings, and can never be stronger than the intermediary. Make a reasonable effort to find the original first; if the original exists but is paywalled or untranslated, say so.

IV — Literature Overview

Lists several sources on a topic to show the shape of the literature. Separate sources with semicolons. Order by significance or chronology and say which is which if the order is not obvious.

EX-15 For an in-depth discussion of the Democratic Peace Thesis, see Anna Geis and Wolfgang Wagner, "How Far Is It from Königsberg to Kandahar? Democratic Peace and Democratic Violence in International Relations," *Review of International Studies* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 37, No. 4] (2011): pp. 1555–1577; Brandon C. Prins, "Democratic Politics and Dispute Challenges: Examining the Effects of Regime Type on Conflict Reciprocation, 1816–1992," *International Journal of Peace Studies* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 8, No. 01] (2003): pp. 61–74; and Sebastian Rosato, "The Flawed Logic of Democratic Peace Theory," *The American Political Science Review* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 97, No. 4] (2003): pp. 585–602. For a capitalist alternative, see Erik Gartzke, "The Capitalist Peace," *American Journal of Political Science* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 51, No. 1] (2007): pp. 166–191.

V — Commentary

Carries relevant material that would interrupt the main text. Also the place to record caveats about a source's reliability, to explain how a date or attribution was established, or to note what you could not confirm.

EX-16 Although the *Fallout* franchise introduced it to popular culture, the late 1940s and 1950s saw the actual introduction of small portable nuclear weapons for the battlefield.

EX-17 This figure appears in three outlets, all of which trace to the same unnamed ministry official. Treated here as a single source, not three.

VI — Subsequent Citations

After the first full citation, use the short form: author surname, shortened title where one is needed, and locator.

Full Michael Beckley, *Unrivaled: Why America Will Remain the World's Sole Superpower* [Monograph] (Cornell University Press: 2018): pp. 25–27.

Short Beckley, *Unrivaled*, p. 45.

Repeat Ibid., p. 51.

- Include the shortened title whenever the piece cites more than one work by the same author.
- Where two authors share a surname, include first initials in every short form.
- *Ibid.* refers to the source in the immediately preceding footnote and nothing else. It breaks silently when footnotes are reordered during drafting, so if a piece is still being restructured, use the short form throughout and convert to Ibid. only on the final pass, or skip it entirely. The short form is never wrong.

Anchoring

Anchor footnotes at the end of the paragraph rather than after each sentence. Where a paragraph draws on several sources, and it would not otherwise be clear which supports which claim, say so inside the footnote: "On force structure, see Kofman; on procurement figures, see the CRS report."

Special Cases

These are the situations that come up constantly in open-source work and that general style guides do not address.

Volatile Sources, Archiving, and Link Rot

A citation that leads nowhere is not a citation. Any source that can be deleted, edited, or moved by someone other than us must be archived at the moment you capture it.

Archive before you cite

- *Always archive:* social media posts of every kind, Telegram and Discord content, personal blogs, forum posts, company press pages, and any government page in a jurisdiction where the page is likely to be revised or removed.
- *Usually unnecessary:* DOI-bearing journal articles, books, and documents held in a formal archive with a permanent identifier.
- Archive the page yourself rather than assuming a copy exists. Capture the archive link and the capture date at the same time.

Append the archive after the URL, in a separate sentence:

> … URL. Archived: ARCHIVE-URL (captured DD Month YYYY).

EX-18 WarMonitor, "Drone Strike Footage Near Kursk," *Telegram* [Video Post; C3] (15 February 2026) https://t.me/warmonitor3/48812. Archived: https://archive.ph/x7k2m (captured 15 February 2026).

Access dates

Continuously updated resources — sanctions lists, flight and vessel trackers, patent and corporate registries, live dashboards — need an access date, because the content you saw is not the content the reader will see. Put it in the parenthetical with the publication date where both exist.

EX-19 US Department of the Treasury, "Specially Designated Nationals List," *US Treasury Dept. Website* [Sanctions List; A1] (US Government: updated 08 March 2026, accessed 11 March 2026) https://sanctionslist.ofac.treas.gov/Home/SdnList.

Deleted, Edited, and Screenshotted Content

- *Deleted after capture:* keep the original URL, keep the archive link, and note the deletion and when you observed it: [Social Media Post; deleted by 16 February 2026; C3].
- *Edited after capture:* cite the version you saw, note that the live version differs, and say how: [Social Media Post; text revised after publication; C3].
- *Screenshot you did not observe live:* this is a secondary citation. Cite the account that circulated the screenshot, open with "Cited in," and rate it accordingly. A screenshot of unknown provenance is F6 and cannot carry a judgment on its own.
- *Reposts and reuploads:* trace to the original account and cite that where you can identify it. Where you cannot, cite the repost and say the original could not be traced.

> **Note V:** Never cite a screenshot as though it were the post. The distinction between "I saw this post" and "I saw an image of this post" is the whole ballgame in a contested information environment.

Non-English and Translated Sources

Give the title in the original, followed by an English translation in square brackets. The description bracket follows in its usual position.

> Author, "Original Title" ["English Translation"], *Location* [Description] (Publisher: Date) URL.

EX-20 Yuan Zheng, "美国对华科技政策的演变" ["The Evolution of US Technology Policy Toward China"], *American Studies Quarterly* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 38, No. 2; original in Chinese; B2] (2024): pp. 44–61.

- *Transliteration:* pinyin without tone marks for Chinese; BGN/PCGN for Russian, Ukrainian, and other Cyrillic scripts; Hepburn for Japanese; Revised Romanization for Korean. Where a person or organization uses a different English spelling of their own name, follow them.
- *Ukrainian place names* take Ukrainian transliteration (Kyiv, Odesa, Kharkiv) unless quoting a source directly.
- *Who translated it:* if a published English translation exists, credit the translator in the author slot with (trans.), and add translated from and the original language to the description bracket: Fyodor Dostoevsky; Richard Pevear (trans.) and Larissa Volokhonsky (trans.), *Demons* [Novel; translated from Russian] (Vintage: 1995). If you translated it yourself, add "translation by author" to the description bracket.
- *Machine translation must be disclosed* — [machine translation; original in Russian] — and any quotation drawn from machine-translated text must be checked against the original before publication, or not used as a quotation.

Satellite, Aerial, and Geospatial Imagery

Imagery needs enough metadata that another analyst can pull the same frame. Provider, capture date, resolution, and coordinates all belong in the citation.

EX-21 Planet Labs PBC, "PlanetScope Imagery of Dzhankoi Airbase," *Planet Explorer* [Commercial Satellite Imagery; 3 m resolution; 45.7086° N, 34.4142° E; B2] (Planet Labs PBC: captured 09 March 2026, accessed 11 March 2026) https://www.planet.com/explorer/.

- Distinguish the *capture date* from the *publication date* and from your *access date*. Where they differ and it matters, give all three.
- Where a geolocation is your own analytic conclusion rather than source metadata, say so in a commentary footnote and give the reasoning. Do not present an inference as a coordinate.

- The same applies to drone and dashcam footage: cite the upload, and treat the location as an analytic judgment unless the source states it.

AI-Generated Content

Output from a generative model is a record of what a model produced, not evidence about the world. It is cited so the reader knows it was used — not to support a factual claim.

> Model Name and Version, "Description of Output," *Platform* [Description] (Developer: Date) URL.

EX-22 Claude Opus 4.5, "Summary of open-source reporting on PLA joint logistics," *Claude.ai* [AI Model Output; prompt and full transcript on file; F6] (Anthropic: 12 March 2026).

- *Default rating is F6.* Model output is unverifiable at the point of generation. It may never be the sole support for a judgment, and any factual claim it produces must be independently sourced and cited to that source instead.
- Record the model name and version. "ChatGPT" or "Claude" without a version is not a citation.
- Retain the prompt and full transcript and say so in the description bracket. Output that cannot be reproduced or inspected should not appear in a published piece.
- *Disclose analytic use.* Where a model was used to summarize, translate, or draft any portion of a published product, say so in the piece — not only in a footnote.
- AI-generated *imagery or audio encountered in the wild* is a different matter: cite it as the media object it is, and treat the question of whether it is synthetic as an analytic judgment requiring its own footnote and evidence.

Multiple Sources in One Footnote

Because footnotes are anchored at paragraph ends, most will carry more than one source. Separate them with semicolons, and use a final "and" before the last where the list is read as a set.

EX-23 On force design, see Michael Kofman and Rob Lee, "Not Built for Purpose: The Russian Military's Ill-Fated Force Design," *War on the Rocks* [Defense Analysis Article; B2] (02 June 2022) https://warontherocks.com/2022/06/not-built-for-purpose-the-russian-militarys-ill-fated-force-design/; on drone employment, Samuel Bendett, "Russia's Use of Drones in Ukraine," *Center for Naval Analyses* [Think Tank Report; A2] (2024) https://www.cna.org/reports/2024/russia-drones; and on casualty figures, which remain contested, see the commentary at n. 14 above.

- Where sources disagree, say so in the footnote rather than silently picking one.
- Use n. and ns. to cross-reference your own earlier footnotes.

Source Reliability & Credibility

This rating system is optional but strongly encouraged, and effectively mandatory for any source whose reliability a reader might reasonably question. Ratings go inside the description bracket: [Social Media Post; C3].

Two separate things are being rated, and keeping them separate is the entire point of the system:

- *Letters A–F rate the source.* How much confidence does its track record, access, and method warrant?
- *Numbers 1–6 rate the information.* How well is this particular claim corroborated, independent of who is making it?

> **Note VI:** A highly reliable source can report an uncorroborated claim (A3). An unreliable outlet can report something later confirmed by independent evidence (E1). Rating them on one axis destroys exactly the information the system exists to preserve.

The Matrix

Credibility ↓ / Reliability →	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	A1	B1	C1	D1	E1	F1
2	A2	B2	C2	D2	E2	F2
3	A3	B3	C3	D3	E3	F3
4	A4	B4	C4	D4	E4	F4
5	A5	B5	C5	D5	E5	F5
6	A6	B6	C6	D6	E6	F6

Reliability of the Source (A–F)

Grade	Meaning	What it means in practice
A	Highly Reliable	Long track record, direct access, transparent method. Errors are rare and corrected.
B	Usually Reliable	Generally sound, but with known institutional framing, incentives, or occasional error.
C	Fairly Reliable	Mixed or short record. Sometimes right, sometimes not. Requires corroboration.
D	Not Usually Reliable	More often wrong than right, or method is opaque. Use only with strong corroboration.
E	Unreliable	Demonstrated pattern of error or deliberate distortion. Treat as a claim about the source, not the world.
F	Unknown	No basis on which to judge. Anonymous, new, or unattributable.

Credibility of the Information (1–6)

Grade	Meaning	What it means in practice
1	Confirmed	Corroborated by independent sources or direct evidence.
2	Probable	Consistent with other reporting; not independently confirmed.
3	Possible	Plausible and not contradicted, but uncorroborated.
4	Doubtful	In tension with better-supported information.
5	Improbable	Contradicted by evidence, or internally incoherent.
6	Unknown	No basis for judging the claim either way.

Zones and Required Handling

Zone	Blocks	Handling
Green	A1, A2, B1, B2, C1	May be used as core evidence. C1 is the weakest of these; note when leaning on it.
Yellow	A3, B3, C2, C3, D1, D2, E1	Usable with framing and corroboration. Say in the text that the claim is not confirmed.
Orange	A4, B4, C4, D3, D4, E2, E3	Weak. Use only where necessary and where the caveat is stated in a footnote.
Red	A5, B5, C5, D5, E4, E5	Likely misleading or false. Cite only to identify and challenge the claim, never to support one.
Gray	All 6s and all F blocks	Unverifiable. May be cited to show that a claim is circulating; may never be the sole support for a judgment.

> **Note VII:** The Red and Gray zones are not bans. Documenting a false or unverifiable claim is often the point of the piece. What the zones govern is what the claim may be made to *carry*: a Red-zone source can support "this is being asserted," never "this is the case."

Where Sources Typically Start

The table below gives *typical starting points* for the reliability grade only. It does not assign grades. A think tank with a bad record on a subject is not a B because it is a think tank, and a pseudonymous account with three years of verified geolocations is not a D because it is anonymous. The grade is the analyst's judgment, made on the record, and adjusted for the specific source and the specific question.

Typical start	Source type	What to watch
A	Government documents, raw satellite imagery, peer-reviewed research	May still carry bias; interpretation varies; can be outdated
B	Think tank reports, major news outlets, corporate reporting	Institutional framing; funding and incentive structures; conflicts of interest
B–C	Local and regional media	Context dependent; access advantage but narrower

Typical start	Source type	What to watch
		verification capacity
C	Established OSINT accounts and social media with a track record	Highly variable; check the specific account, not the category
C–D	Blogs and independent analysts	Check track record and whether prior claims held up
D–F	Anonymous or unattributable channels (Telegram, Discord, forums)	High risk; provenance often unrecoverable
E	Outlets with a demonstrated record of state-directed distortion	Actively misleading; useful as evidence of messaging, not of fact
F	AI model output; unattributed screenshots; sources of unknown origin	Unverifiable at the point of capture

Rated Examples

EX-24 Michael Kofman and Rob Lee, "Not Built for Purpose: The Russian Military's Ill-Fated Force Design," *War on the Rocks* [Defense Analysis Article; B2] (02 June 2022) https://warontherocks.com/2022/06/not-built-for-purpose-the-russian-militarys-ill-fated-force-design/.

EX-25 Samuel Bendett, "Russia's Use of Drones in Ukraine," *Center for Naval Analyses* [Think Tank Report; A2] (2024) https://www.cna.org/reports/2024/russia-drones.

EX-26 OSINTdefender, "Ukrainian Drone Strike Footage Near Bakhmut," *X* [Social Media Post; C3] (14 February 2026) https://x.com/sentdefender/status/1234567890. Archived: https://archive.ph/abc123 (captured 14 February 2026). Geolocation is this author's assessment based on the treeline and road junction visible at 0:12; not stated by the poster.

Analytic Standards and Estimative Language

These standards are adapted from ICD 203, the US Intelligence Community's analytic tradecraft standard. They apply to every product published under this brand.

The Standards

- *Be objective.* Mitigate your own biases. Consider alternative explanations and say why you rejected them. Do not shape a judgment to fit a political preference, a sponsor, or an audience.
- *Use all available open sources.* Where an important source was unavailable — paywalled, untranslated, deleted, or beyond your access — say so rather than writing around the gap.

- *Describe the quality of your sourcing.* Use the ratings under Source Reliability & Credibility and explain in footnotes where a source is weak, contested, or singular.
- *Separate information from judgment.* The reader must always be able to tell what a source said from what you concluded. Attribute the first; own the second.
- *Express uncertainty explicitly*, using the vocabulary below.
- *Make the argument logical and visible.* Show the reasoning that connects evidence to conclusion, not just the conclusion.
- *Be replicable.* A competent reader with your footnotes should be able to reach your sources and test your reasoning.

Estimative Language

The requirement to express uncertainty means nothing without a shared vocabulary. Use these terms, and use them consistently.

Term	Approximate range	Notes
almost certainly / nearly certain	95–99%	Reserve for judgments with strong, multi-source support
very likely / highly probable	80–95%	
likely / probable	55–80%	
roughly even chance	45–55%	Use when the evidence genuinely does not favor either side
unlikely / improbable	20–45%	
very unlikely / highly improbable	05–20%	
almost no chance / remote	01–05%	

- *Do not mix verbal and numeric expressions of the same judgment* in one sentence. Pick one register.
- *Avoid "possible" as an estimative term.* Nearly everything is possible; the word conveys no information. Use a term from the table.
- *Avoid "could," "may," and "might"* as substitutes for a probability judgment. They read as analysis while committing to nothing.
- *Never hedge a judgment you are unwilling to make.* If the evidence will not support an estimate, say that the evidence will not support an estimate.

Confidence Is Not Probability

Likelihood and confidence are different measurements and must be stated separately. Likelihood is how probable you think the thing is. Confidence is how good your basis for saying so is.

Confidence	Basis
High	Multiple independent, well-rated sources; consistent evidence; sound method
Moderate	Credible sourcing with gaps, limited corroboration, or some conflicting evidence
Low	Fragmentary, single-source, or poorly-rated evidence; significant assumptions

A judgment can be high-likelihood and low-confidence: "Russian forces very likely repositioned two battalions eastward (low confidence; based on a single commercial imagery pass and one uncorroborated local report)." That sentence is honest. "Russian forces repositioned two battalions eastward" is not.

Assumptions and Intelligence Gaps

- State load-bearing assumptions explicitly. If the judgment collapses when the assumption fails, the reader needs to know what the assumption is.
- Name the gaps. What would you need to see to raise or lower confidence? What would falsify the judgment?
- Where you have changed a previously published judgment, say so and say why.

House Style

Consistency matters more than any individual choice here. Where this section is silent, pick a convention, apply it throughout the piece, and flag it for inclusion in the next revision.

Dates, Times, and Numbers

- Dates in text and in citations: DD Month YYYY — 08 March 2026. Months spelled out.
- Date ranges use en dashes: 1816–1992. Do not abbreviate the second year.
- Times of events: UTC, in 24-hour format, with local time in parentheses where it matters — 0430 UTC (0730 local).
- Spell out one through nine; use numerals for 10 and above. Always numerals with units of measure, percentages, money, and in ranges.
- Large numbers: 1,200 · 45,000 · 3.2 million · $1.4 billion.
- Percentages: use the numeral and the symbol — 45%. In estimative ranges, 20–45%.
- Currency: US dollars unless stated. For other currencies, give the amount and a USD conversion with the conversion date: €4.2 billion (about $4.5 billion at March 2026 rates).

Names, Ranks, and Acronyms

- People: full name at first mention, surname thereafter. Include the role at first mention where the reader will need it.

- Ranks: full rank at first mention, standard abbreviation thereafter — Lieutenant General Ivan Popov, then Lt. Gen. Popov.
- Acronyms: spell out at first use with the acronym in parentheses; use the acronym thereafter. In long documents, re-expand at the start of each major section. Do not introduce an acronym you use only once.
- Do not assume the reader knows military or intelligence shorthand. Expand it or explain it.
- Military equipment: give the local designation with the NATO reporting name in parentheses at first use — Su-57 (NATO: Felon).
- Units and formations: give the local designation and an English gloss at first use where the structure will not be obvious.

Place Names and Contested Terminology

- Use the form most familiar to an English-language reader, with a local form at first mention where it aids identification.
- Where a place name is itself contested, choose a convention, state it once near the top of the piece, and hold to it. Do not switch mid-document, and do not vary the choice to suit a passage's argument.
- Naming is a political act in contested territory. The goal is not neutrality-by-avoidance but transparency: the reader should know what convention you adopted and why.
- When quoting a source, keep the source's own terminology inside the quotation and note the difference if it matters.

Quotation and Attribution

- Quote sparingly and only where the exact wording carries the weight. Paraphrase otherwise, and cite either way.
- Quotations must be exact. Use [square brackets] for any insertion and an ellipsis for any omission. Never edit a quotation to change its sense.
- Reproduce errors in quoted material and mark them [sic].
- Attribute claims to their actual origin, not to the outlet that repeated them. Three outlets carrying one anonymous official is one source.
- Distinguish what a source *reported* from what a source *claimed* from what a source *confirmed*. These are different verbs and they are not interchangeable.

Formatting

- Italicize titles of larger works, publication names, ship names, and non-English terms on first use.
- Where a publishing platform cannot render italics, substitute clear underlining and apply it consistently throughout the piece.
- Use en dashes for ranges, em dashes for parenthetical breaks, and hyphens for compounds.

- One space after a period.
- Serial comma throughout.

Corrections, Versioning, and Checklist

Corrections Policy

Open-source analysis is credible only to the extent that it corrects itself visibly. The correction record is part of the product.

- *Substantive corrections* — anything that changes a fact, a figure, an attribution, or a judgment — get a dated correction note at the top or bottom of the piece stating what was wrong and what it now says. Do not quietly amend.
- *Non-substantive fixes* — typos, broken links, formatting — may be made silently.
- *Retractions* leave the original text visible with a clear retraction notice attached. Deleting a retracted piece destroys the record.
- *Updates* to a still-developing story are labeled as updates with their own date, and do not overwrite the original judgment. Where the new information changes a judgment, say what changed and why.
- Where a correction originates outside the organization, credit the person or outlet that caught it.

Versioning of Living Documents

- Any document intended to be revised carries a version number and a date on its first page.
- Every revision adds a changelog entry naming what changed. Corrections are distinguished from additions.
- Where a change alters existing practice, say whether prior work needs to be redone.

Pre-Publication Checklist

Run this before anything goes out.

☐ Every footnote has an author, a title, a location, and a description bracket, or a stated reason one is absent.

☐ Every URL resolves, right now, from a browser that is not logged in.

☐ Every volatile source has an archive link and a capture date.

☐ Every continuously updated source has an access date.

☐ Every journal article states its review status: Peer-Reviewed Article, or Journal Article with a review-status qualifier.

☐ Every source behind a paywall, login, or regional block says so in the description bracket.

☐ Ratings are present on every source a reader might question, and no rating was assigned by category alone.

☐ No Red- or Gray-zone source is carrying a factual judgment on its own.

☐ Quotations have been checked against the original, including any translated ones.

☐ Machine translation and AI assistance are disclosed where used.

☐ Every estimative term comes from the Estimative Language table; no stray "possible," "could," or "may."

☐ Likelihood and confidence are stated separately for each major judgment.

☐ Load-bearing assumptions are stated, and gaps are named.

☐ Analytic judgments are clearly distinguished from what sources said.

☐ Short-form citations match a full citation that appears earlier in the piece.

☐ Every Ibid. still points at the source immediately above it after the final reorder.

☐ Acronyms are expanded at first use.

☐ Contested terminology follows one stated convention throughout.

Appendix A — Abbreviations

Abbrev.	Meaning	Abbrev.	Meaning
p.	A single page	n.d.	No publication date
pp.	Two or more pages	sic	Thus it was written — marks an error present in the original
n. / ns.	A note or notes in another work	et al.	And others — four or more authors
NB / N.B.	Nota bene: note well	e.g.	For example
i.e.	That is; in other words	Cf.	Compare
Ibid.	In the same place — the immediately preceding note	c. / ca.	Circa
Ed. / Eds.	Editor / Editors	Trans.	Translated by
Contr.	Contributor(s)	d.	Died
Vol. / Vols.	Volume / Volumes	No. / Nos.	Issue number(s)
Eps.	Episode(s)	Sec. / Secs.	Section / Sections
Sub. / Subs.	Sub-section(s)	Art.	Article (of a treaty or statute)

Note VIII: Sec. means *section*, not seconds. Timestamps in audio and video use the source's own clock format — 30:15–32:40 — not minute and second abbreviations.

Appendix B — Source Description Library

Descriptions go first inside the square brackets. Pick the most specific one that fits, then add details, qualifiers, language, access, and a rating where they apply, in that order. If nothing here fits, write a plain description of ten words or fewer and send a note so it can be added.

The library holds 771 descriptions in 16 categories. Each category is split into groups so that a long list stays quick to scan.

Government and Legal

Group	Descriptions
Legislative	Congressional Report · CRS Report · Parliamentary Report · Public Law / Statute · Testimony Transcript · Hearing · Bill · Resolution · Committee Report · Conference Report · Committee Print · Prepared Testimony · Legislative Debate Record · Parliamentary Question · Roll-Call Vote Record · Legislative History · Constitution · Constitutional Amendment · Local Ordinance
Executive and regulatory	Government Report · Ministry Publication · Defense White Paper · Executive Order · Regulatory Filing · Government Press Release · Public Safety Announcement · Presidential Proclamation · Presidential Memorandum · National Security Directive · Signing Statement · Decree · Regulation · Proposed Rule · Final Rule · Federal Register Notice · Official Gazette Notice · Agency Guidance · Public Comment · Government Fact Sheet · National Strategy Document · Government White Paper · Consultation Paper · Official Speech · Official Statement · Press Briefing Transcript · Government Web Page · Government Circular · Travel Advisory · Export Control List · Commission Report · Public Inquiry Report · Environmental Impact Statement · Official Biography
Party-state systems	Party Document · Party Congress Report · Party Regulation · State Planning Document
Courts and legal practice	Court Record · Legal Opinion · Indictment · Deposition · Arbitration Ruling · Court Opinion · Dissenting Opinion · Judgment · Court Order · Court Filing · Legal Brief · Amicus Brief · Complaint · Plea Agreement · Sentencing Memorandum · Affidavit · Sworn Declaration · Search Warrant · Trial Transcript · Trial Exhibit · Oral Argument · Docket Sheet · Consent Decree · Settlement Agreement · Administrative Ruling · Court-Martial Record · Contract · Legal Treatise
Budget, procurement, and oversight	Budget Document · Procurement Record · Public Tender / Contract · Inspector General Report · Central Bank Report · Budget Justification · Contract Award Notice · Grant Award Record · Spending Database Record · Audit Report · GAO Report · CBO Cost Estimate
Registries and public records	Patent Filing · Trademark Database · Sanctions List · Police Report · Sanctions Designation Notice · Land / Property Record · Vital Record · Professional License Record · Accident Investigation Report · Wanted Notice
Elections, lobbying, and disclosure	Election Results · Campaign Finance Filing · Lobbying Disclosure · Foreign Agent Registration · Financial Disclosure · Party Platform · Campaign Material · Ballot Measure
Intelligence and released records	Intelligence Assessment · FOIA-Released Document · Declassified Document · National Intelligence Estimate · Threat Assessment · MDR-Released Document

International Organizations and Diplomacy

Group	Descriptions
UN system	UN Report · UN Resolution · Peacekeeping Report · Secretary-General Report · Panel of Experts Report · Special Rapporteur Report · Commission of Inquiry Report · UN Meeting Record · UN Voting Record · Treaty Body Observations · IAEA Report · Inspection Report

Group	Descriptions
Treaties and agreements	Treaty · Executive Agreement · Convention · Protocol · Memorandum of Understanding · Status of Forces Agreement · Arms Control Agreement · Peace Agreement · Ceasefire Agreement · Trade Agreement · Treaty Reservation · Negotiating Record
Diplomatic practice	Diplomatic Cable · Diplomatic Note · Joint Statement · Joint Communiqué · Summit Declaration · Foreign Ministry Briefing · Official Readout
Alliances and regional bodies	NATO Publication · Regional Org Publication · NATO Standardization Agreement · EU Legal Act · Council Conclusions
International finance and development	World Bank Dataset · IMF Report · WHO Health Data · WTO Trade Data · OECD Report · World Bank Report · Development Bank Report · IMF Country Report · WTO Dispute Ruling
International courts and monitoring	International Court Ruling · Election Monitoring Report · Advisory Opinion · International Court Filing · Arrest Warrant

Academic and Research

Group	Descriptions
Books	Monograph · Trade Book · Edited Volume · Book Section · Textbook · Open Textbook · Handbook Chapter · Scholarly Edition · Anthology · Collected Works · Multivolume Work · Memoir · Autobiography · Biography · Published Diary · Published Correspondence · Published Document Collection · Official History · Self-Published Book · Foreword or Introduction · Exhibition Catalog · Pamphlet
Journal literature	Peer-Reviewed Article · Journal Article · Literature Review · Meta-Analysis · Review Article · Systematic Review · Book Review · Review Essay · Research Note · Scholarly Commentary · Reply or Rejoinder · Journal Editorial · Special Issue Introduction · Forum Contribution · Case Study · Replication Study · Registered Report · Data Paper · Law Review Article · Student Note · Professional Journal Article · Abstract · Erratum · Retraction Notice
Research papers and reports	Working Paper · Whitepaper · Preprint Paper · Research Report · Field Research Report · Technical Report · Occasional Paper · Discussion Paper · Research Brief · Pre-Registration · Research Protocol · Grant Proposal
Degrees and student work	Dissertation · Thesis · Undergraduate Thesis · Capstone Project · Student Paper
Conferences and talks	Conference Paper · Lecture (Recorded) · Conference Proceedings · Conference Abstract · Conference Poster · Conference Presentation · Keynote Address · Panel Discussion · Webinar · Workshop Report
Unpublished and in progress	Unpublished Manuscript · Forthcoming Work · Unpublished Data

Reference, Data, and Statistics

Group	Descriptions
Reference entries	Reference Work Entry · Encyclopedia Article · Dictionary Entry · Biographical Entry · Wiki Article · Country Profile
Reference volumes	Statistical Yearbook · Factbook · Handbook · Almanac · Atlas · Gazetteer · Bibliography · Annotated Bibliography · Chronology · Glossary · Directory · Style Manual · Field Guide · Library Catalog Record

Group	Descriptions
Datasets	Census Data · Government Dataset · Academic Dataset · Index Dataset · Data Aggregator · Replication Data · Event Dataset · Time-Series Data · Trade Statistics · Database Record · Codebook
Polling and surveys	Public Opinion Poll · Poll Crosstabs · Survey Data · Survey Instrument · Expert Survey
Statistical products	Statistical Release · Data Dashboard · Interactive Data Tool · Forecast or Model Output · Prediction Market Data
Charts and figures	Reproduced Figure · Data Visualization · Infographic

Think Tank, Industry, and Finance

Group	Descriptions
Think tanks and policy shops	Think Tank Report · Policy Brief · Policy Analysis · Strategic Report · Issue Brief · Backgrounder · Expert Commentary · Task Force Report · Scenario Study · Event Transcript · Interactive Tracker · Sponsored Research Report · Advocacy Group Report · Consultancy Report
Corporate disclosure	Quarterly Report · Annual Report · Investor Presentation · SEC Filing · Earnings Call Transcript · Corporate Press Release · M&A Filing · Bankruptcy Record · Stock Exchange Filing · Prospectus · Proxy Statement · Financial Statement · Auditor Report · Sustainability Report · Shareholder Letter · Corporate Blog Post · Company Web Page · Job Posting
Markets and finance	Credit Rating Report · Market Research Report · Analyst Note · Market Data · Commodity Price Data
Trade and industry	Industry Whitepaper · Trade Journal Article · Professional Association Report · Technical Standard · Product Datasheet · Product Brochure · Product Catalog · Trade Show Material · User Manual · Safety Data Sheet · Business Survey
Ownership and commercial records	Business Registry Record · Ownership Database · Beneficial Ownership Record · Customs Record · Bill of Lading · Vessel Registry Record · Aircraft Registry Record · Insurance Record

News and Media

Group	Descriptions
Reporting	News Article · News Report · Wire Service Report · Investigative Report · Magazine Article · Newsletter Article · Journalist Newsletter · Fact-Check · Conflict Reporting Platform · Feature Article · Live Blog · News Brief · Explainer · Published Interview · Profile · Obituary · Local News Report · Student Newspaper Article · Historical Newspaper Article · Press Pool Report · Aggregated News Report
Opinion and analysis	News Analysis · Editorial / Op-Ed · Column · Letter to the Editor · Editorial Cartoon · Satire · Sponsored Content
Broadcast, audio, and video	Broadcast Transcript · TV Broadcast · Radio Broadcast · Live-Streamed Broadcast · Podcast · Video · Broadcast Interview · Press Conference · Video Essay · Newsreel
State and party media	State Media Report · State Media Commentary · Party Newspaper Editorial
Monitoring and translation	Media Monitoring Translation · Press Digest
Visual and data journalism	News Photograph · Photo Essay · Data Journalism Article · Interactive Feature

Social, Web, and User-Generated

Group	Descriptions
Posts	Social Media Post · Video Post · Reposted Content · Blog Post · Comment Section · Thread · Reply · Quote Post · Story Post · Short-Form Video · Livestream · Livestream Chat Log · Comment · Meme
Messaging and channels	Channel Post · Group Chat Message · Direct Message · Voice Message · Forwarded Message · Chat Log Export
Accounts and platform features	Account Profile · Account Metadata · Professional Profile · Community Note · Social Network Data
Forums and community	Forum Post · Forum Discussion · Crowdsourced Investigation · Q&A Site Answer · Wiki Edit History · User Review · Mailing List Post · Petition · Crowdfunding Page · Marketplace Listing · Memorial Page
Web pages	Archived Web Content · Web Page · Personal Website · About Page · FAQ Page
Capture and provenance	Screenshot (Provenance Verified) · Screenshot (Provenance Unverified) · Deleted Post (Archived) · Edited Post (Archived) · Screen Recording
Synthetic and inauthentic	AI-Generated Image · AI-Generated Video · AI-Generated Audio · Suspected Synthetic Media · Manipulated Media · Suspected Inauthentic Account Post

Imagery, Geospatial, and Tracking

Group	Descriptions
Overhead imagery	Commercial Satellite Imagery · Government Satellite Release · Satellite Time-Series · Remote Sensing Dataset · Synthetic Aperture Radar Imagery · Multispectral Imagery · Thermal / Infrared Imagery · Nighttime Lights Data · Active Fire Data · Aerial Photograph · Historical Aerial Photograph · Declassified Reconnaissance Imagery · Annotated Satellite Imagery
Ground-level imagery and footage	Geotagged Photo · Drone Footage · Photograph (Verified) · Video Footage (Verified) · Audio Recording · Livestream Archive · Photograph (Unverified) · Video Footage (Unverified) · Street-Level Imagery · CCTV Footage · Dashcam Footage · Body-Camera Footage · Helmet-Camera Footage · Webcam Feed
Maps and geodata	GIS Dataset · OpenStreetMap Data · Terrain / Elevation Model · Maritime Tracking Map · Map · Topographic Map · Nautical Chart · Historical Map · Control-of-Terrain Map · Interactive Map · Crowdsourced Map · 3D Reconstruction · Administrative Boundary Data
Movement tracking	Flight Tracking Data · Ship Tracking (AIS) · Rail Tracking Data · Port Authority Log · Vehicle Tracking Data · Aviation Accident Database · Port Call Record · Satellite Orbit Data · Launch Notification · Fitness Tracker Data · Commercial Location Data · Vehicle Registration Record
Notices, signals, and sensors	NOTAM · Navigational Warning · GPS Interference Data · Scanner Audio · Seismic Data · Weather Data
Verification products	Geolocation Analysis · Chronolocation Analysis · File Metadata · Reverse Image Search Result · Visual Forensic Analysis

Military and Defense

Group	Descriptions
Doctrine and manuals	Military Doctrine Publication · Training Manual (Public) · Training Manual (Leaked) · Field Manual · Joint Publication · Technical Manual · Law of War Manual · Rules of Engagement · Service Strategy Document · Posture Statement · Operating Concept
Operational records	After-Action Report · Operations Order · Situation Report · War Diary · Unit History · Lessons-Learned Report · Staff Study · Captured Document · Intercepted Communication · Service Record · Award Citation · Casualty List
Assessments and estimates	Defense Analysis Article · Order of Battle Assessment · Casualty Estimate · Wargame or Simulation · Net Assessment · Campaign Assessment · Daily Intelligence Update · Equipment Loss Tally · Exercise Report · War College Paper
Force data and equipment	Defense Procurement Database · Arms Transfer Database · Conflict Incident Database · Military Reference Yearbook · Table of Organization and Equipment · Equipment Recognition Guide · Weapons System Fact Sheet · Selected Acquisition Report · Arms Catalog · End-User Certificate · Arms Export License Record · Weapons Tracing Report
Official messaging	Defense Ministry Briefing · Military Press Release · Operational Update · Exercise Announcement · Recruitment Material
Personal and frontline accounts	Veteran / Soldier Account · Military Blogger Post · POW Statement · Combat Footage
Armed group and propaganda material	Armed Group Statement · Claim of Responsibility · Propaganda Video · Propaganda Magazine · Propaganda Leaflet · Manifesto · Religious Ruling · Leader Message

Cyber and Technical

Group	Descriptions
Threat reporting	Threat Intelligence Report · Malware Analysis · Security Blog Post · Dark Web Monitoring Report · Data Breach Disclosure · Security Advisory · Security Incident Report · Threat Actor Profile · Indicators of Compromise · Sandbox Analysis Report · Detection Rule · Takedown Report · Platform Transparency Report
Vulnerabilities	CVE / NVD Entry · Vulnerability Disclosure · Proof-of-Concept Code · Bug Bounty Report
Infrastructure and network data	Network Scanning Data · Sensor Network Data · Smart Device Metadata · Blockchain Transaction Record · WHOIS Record · DNS Record · Passive DNS Data · Certificate Transparency Log · BGP Routing Data · Internet Outage Data · IP Geolocation Data · Packet Capture · Log File · Smart Contract
Code and software	Code Repository · Technical Documentation · Software · Code Commit · Issue Tracker Entry · Release Notes · API Documentation · Technical Specification · Request for Comments · Mobile App · App Store Listing
Leaks and illicit markets	Leaked Dataset · Leaked Document · Internal Document · Leak Database Entry · Leak Site Post · Dark Web Forum Post · Dark Web Marketplace Listing · Ransom Note · Hacktivist Claim · Paste Site Post
AI systems	AI Model Output · Model Card · Dataset Card · Benchmark Result
Platform rules	Terms of Service · Privacy Policy · Community Guidelines

Science, Health, and Environment

Group	Descriptions
Clinical and public health	Clinical Trial Registration · Clinical Trial Results · Clinical Practice Guideline · Case Report · Epidemiological Bulletin · Disease Outbreak Notice · Drug or Device Approval Record
Science and environment	Scientific Assessment Report · Environmental Monitoring Data · Laboratory Protocol
Specimens and sites	Museum Specimen Record · Taxonomic Description · Archaeological Site Report

NGO, Humanitarian, and Civil Society

Group	Descriptions
Reports and investigations	Human Rights Report · Transparency Org Report · Anti-Corruption Report · Field Investigation Report · Open-Source Investigation · Shadow Report · Press Freedom Report
Humanitarian operations	Crisis / Relief Update · NGO Data · Humanitarian Situation Report · Needs Assessment · Casualty Recording Database · Witness Testimony
Statements and filings	Public Statement · Open Letter · Charity Filing · Foundation Grant Record

Archival and Primary Sources

Group	Descriptions
Archival records	Archival Material · Primary Source · Historical Document · Manuscript · Archival Collection · Personal Papers · Finding Aid · Meeting Minutes · Telegram · Ledger · Logbook · Colonial Administrative Record · Mission Record · Church Record · Genealogical Record · Will or Probate Record · Passenger List
Personal writing and testimony	Letter · Memo · Diary Entry · Field Notes · Oral History · Oral Tradition
Printed and recorded ephemera	Broadside · Leaflet · Ephemera · Newspaper Clipping · Archival Photograph · Archival Audio Recording

Interviews, Communications, and Author's Own Work

Group	Descriptions
Interviews	Personal Interview · Recorded Interview · Anonymized Interview · Background Briefing · Focus Group · Survey Response
Communications	Personal Communication · E-mail · Phone Call · Text Message · Video Call · Q&A Remarks
Fieldwork	Field Observation · Site Visit Notes
Author's own work	Author's Calculation · Author's Compilation · Author's Translation · Author's Photograph · Author's Dataset · Author's Figure

Literary, Artistic, and Creative Works

Group	Descriptions
Literature	Novel · Short Story · Poem · Play · Essay · Graphic Novel · Comic
Classical and sacred texts	Classical Text · Sacred Text · Chronicle
Film, television, and music	Film · Documentary Film · Short Film · Television Episode · Television Series · Screenplay · Music Recording · Song · Music Video · Musical Score
Art, objects, and performance	Artwork · Poster · Museum Object · Exhibition · Monument or Inscription · Live Performance
Games	Video Game · Tabletop Game · Game Rulebook · Game Scenario

Education, Institutional, and General

Group	Descriptions
Teaching materials	Syllabus · Lecture Notes · Lecture Slides · Course Reader · Online Course Module · Study Guide · Lesson Plan · Curriculum Standard · Standardized Test Material
Institutional documents	Course Catalog · Accreditation Report · Institutional Research Report · Program Review · Institutional Policy · Strategic Plan · Charter or Bylaws · Code of Conduct · Organization Chart · Standard Operating Procedure · Organizational Newsletter · Résumé / CV
General	Advertisement · Presentation · Speech · Sermon · Press Kit · Flyer · Sign or Signage · Label or Packaging · Receipt or Invoice · Event Program · Form or Questionnaire

Qualifiers

A qualifier follows the details and describes the copy of the source you are citing, not its kind: [Field Manual; leaked; scan]. Use only the ones a reader needs to weigh the source. A format qualifier is for a source you have in an unexpected form, such as a speech you cite from its transcript; a Video Post does not also need *video*.

Group	Qualifiers
Provenance	leaked · declassified · FOIA-released · redacted · captured · official release · provenance verified · provenance unverified
Version	preprint · accepted manuscript · version of record · advance online · draft · forthcoming · revised · corrected · retracted · superseded
Review status	peer-reviewed · editor-reviewed · student-edited · not peer-reviewed · review status unclear
Format	transcript · video · audio · scan · facsimile · microfilm · e-book · audiobook · abstract only · excerpt
Capture status	archived · edited after capture · screenshot only · reupload
Interest	industry-funded · government-funded · sponsored · state-affiliated · author affiliated with subject
Synthetic content	AI-generated · AI-assisted · suspected synthetic · digitally altered

Access Notes

Access notes follow any language note and come before the rating: paywalled · metered paywall · free registration required · institutional access · region-restricted · app only. For anything else, a few plain words. A source that is free to read takes no note.

Telling Similar Descriptions Apart

Where two descriptions seem to fit, these notes say which to choose.

Descriptions	How to choose
Preprint Paper · Working Paper	Preprint: posted publicly before peer review. Working Paper: issued in an institution's own series, and may never reach a journal. An accepted manuscript is a Peer-Reviewed Article with the qualifier "accepted manuscript".
Dissertation · Thesis · Undergraduate Thesis	Dissertation, Thesis, Undergraduate Thesis: doctoral, master's, and bachelor's work, in that order (US usage; British usage reverses the first two).
Monograph · Trade Book · Textbook	Monograph: a scholarly book making one sustained argument for specialists, with notes and a bibliography, usually from a university or academic press. Trade Book: written for general readers, usually from a commercial house, even when a scholar wrote it. Textbook: written to teach a field, not to argue a thesis. When you cannot tell Monograph from Trade Book, use Trade Book.
Peer-Reviewed Article · Journal Article · Professional Journal Article · Law Review Article · Trade Journal Article	Peer-Reviewed: refereed by outside scholars. Journal Article: review is of another kind or could not be established, so it takes a review-status qualifier. Professional Journal: reviewed by the journal's own editors. Law Review: edited by law students, usually without peer review. Trade Journal: published by industry press. Check the journal's own statement.
Literature Review · Review Article · Systematic Review · Meta-Analysis	Literature Review: a narrative survey of scholarship. Review Article: a journal article synthesizing a field. Systematic Review: follows a stated, repeatable search method. Meta-Analysis: pools results statistically.
Book Review · Review Essay	Book Review: assesses one book. Review Essay: uses several works to make a wider argument.
Whitepaper · Industry Whitepaper · Government White Paper · Defense White Paper	Whitepaper: any organization's position paper. Industry Whitepaper: a vendor's or trade body's, with a commercial interest. Government White Paper: a formal policy proposal. Defense White Paper: a state's periodic statement of defense policy.
News Article · News Analysis · Feature Article · Explainer	News Article: reports events. News Analysis: a reporter's interpretation of them. Feature Article: a longer narrative not tied to the day's news. Explainer: background on an issue, with no new reporting.
Editorial / Op-Ed · Column · Expert Commentary	Editorial / Op-Ed: the outlet's own voice, or an outside contributor's opinion. Column: a regular writer's recurring signed piece. Expert Commentary: a specialist's short analysis published by their own institution.
State Media Report · State Media Commentary	State Media when a government or ruling party owns or directs the outlet. Evidence of official messaging first, of fact second.
Legal Opinion · Court Opinion · Judgment · Court Order	Legal Opinion: advice from counsel or a law officer. Court Opinion: a court's written reasons. Judgment: the outcome the court entered. Court Order: a direction issued during a case.
Public Law / Statute · Regulation · Executive Order · Decree	Statute: passed by a legislature. Regulation: issued by an agency under a statute. Executive Order: a head of government's direction to the executive branch. Decree: an executive act carrying the force of law, where the system allows it.

Descriptions	How to choose
Testimony Transcript · Prepared Testimony · Hearing · Deposition	Testimony Transcript: what the witness said, as recorded. Prepared Testimony: the written statement submitted beforehand, which can differ. Hearing: the whole proceeding. Deposition: sworn out-of-court testimony taken in litigation.
Treaty · Convention · Protocol · Executive Agreement · Memorandum of Understanding	Treaty: a binding international agreement. Convention: a multilateral treaty open to many states. Protocol: adds to or amends a treaty. Executive Agreement: binding, concluded by the US executive without Senate consent. Memorandum of Understanding: usually a non-binding statement of intent.
Leaked Document · Internal Document · Declassified Document · FOIA-Released Document	Leaked: disclosed without authorization. Internal: not written for publication, but obtained legitimately. Declassified: formerly classified, released by the government's own decision. FOIA-Released: released on request under an information law, often redacted.
Personal Interview · Recorded Interview · Published Interview · Oral History · Personal Communication	Personal Interview: conducted by the author. Recorded Interview: a recording exists. Published Interview: appeared in an outlet. Oral History: recorded testimony held in a collection. Personal Communication: an informal exchange with the author.
Commercial Satellite Imagery · Annotated Satellite Imagery · Geolocation Analysis	Commercial Satellite Imagery: the provider's image. Annotated Satellite Imagery: the image with someone's markings added, so cite the annotator. Geolocation Analysis: a third party's worked conclusion about where something is.
Social Media Post · Channel Post · Reposted Content	Social Media Post: on an account's public feed. Channel Post: sent to a broadcast channel, as on Telegram. Reposted Content: material the account did not originate.

Appendix C — Expanded Footnote Examples

Note IX: Some URLs below are abbreviated to domain level to save space. Live citations require the full URL or DOI.

National Government

EX-27 US Department of Defense, *National Defense Strategy of the United States*, *Defense Department Website* [National Strategy Document; A1] (US Government: 2025) https://media.defense.gov.

EX-28 US Department of State, "Country Reports on Terrorism 2024," *State Department Website* [Government Report; A1] (US Government: 2025) https://www.state.gov.

EX-29 US Census Bureau, "2020 Census Results," *US Census Bureau Website* [Government Dataset; A1] (US Government: 2021) https://www.census.gov.

EX-30 Congressional Research Service, "China Naval Modernization," *CRS Reports Website* [CRS Report; Report #R12345; A1] (US Congress: 2025) https://crsreports.congress.gov.

EX-31 US Government Accountability Office, "Defense Acquisitions Annual Review," *GAO Website* [GAO Report; A1] (GAO: 2024) https://www.gao.gov.

EX-32 Federal Reserve, *Monetary Policy Report*, *Federal Reserve Website* [Central Bank Report; A1] (Federal Reserve: 2025) https://www.federalreserve.gov.

EX-33 UK Ministry of Defence, *Defence in a Competitive Age*, *UK Government Website* [Defense White Paper; A2] (UK MOD: 2021) https://www.gov.uk.

EX-34 National Bureau of Statistics of China, *Statistical Yearbook 2025*, *NBS Website* [Government Dataset; B2] (PRC Government: 2025) http://www.stats.gov.cn.

EX-35 European Commission, "EU Industrial Strategy," *European Commission Website* [Policy Document; A2] (EU: 2024) https://ec.europa.eu.

EX-36 US Department of Justice, "Indictment: United States v. Ivanov," *US Dept. of Justice Website* [Indictment; A1] (DOJ: 2025) https://www.justice.gov.

EX-37 White House, "Executive Order on AI Security," *White House Website* [Executive Order; A1] (US Government: 15 January 2026) https://www.whitehouse.gov.

EX-38 Indian Ministry of Defence, *Annual Report 2024–2025*, *MOD India Website* [Government Report; A2] (Government of India: 2025) https://mod.gov.in.

EX-39 South Korean Ministry of National Defense, *Defense White Paper 2024*, *MND Website* [Defense White Paper; A2] (ROK Government: 2024) https://www.mnd.go.kr.

EX-40 US Department of Commerce, "Export Administration Regulations," *BIS Website* [Regulation; A1] (US Government: 2025) https://www.bis.doc.gov.

EX-41 Canadian Parliament, "Arctic Security Report," *Canadian Parliament Website* [Parliamentary Report; A2] (Government of Canada: 2024) https://www.parl.ca.

EX-42 US National Archives, "Declassified Cold War Documents," *NARA Website* [Archival Material; declassified; A1] (US Government: 2023) https://www.archives.gov.

International Organizations

EX-43 United Nations, *World Population Prospects*, *UN Data Portal* [Global Dataset; A2] (UN: 2025) https://population.un.org.

EX-44 United Nations Security Council, "Resolution 2728," *UN Website* [UN Resolution; A1] (UN: 2024) https://undocs.org.

EX-45 NATO, *NATO 2022 Strategic Concept*, *NATO Website* [NATO Publication; A1] (NATO: 2022) https://www.nato.int.

EX-46 World Bank, *World Development Indicators Dataset*, *World Bank Data Portal* [World Bank Dataset; A2] (World Bank: 2025) https://data.worldbank.org.

EX-47 International Monetary Fund, *World Economic Outlook*, *IMF Website* [IMF Report; A2] (IMF: 2025) https://www.imf.org.

EX-48 World Health Organization, *Global Health Observatory Data*, *WHO Website* [WHO Health Data; A2] (WHO: 2025) https://www.who.int.

EX-49 World Trade Organization, *Trade Profiles 2025*, *WTO Website* [WTO Trade Data; A2] (WTO: 2025) https://www.wto.org.

EX-50 OECD, *Economic Outlook 2025*, *OECD iLibrary* [OECD Report; A2] (OECD: 2025) https://www.oecd.org.

EX-51 African Union, *Peace and Security Report*, *AU Website* [Regional Org Publication; B2] (AU: 2024) https://au.int.

EX-52 International Criminal Court, "Situation in Ukraine Filing," *ICC Website* [International Court Filing; A1] (ICC: 2025) https://www.icc-cpi.int.

Academic

EX-53 Oriana Skylar Mastro, "Military Modernization in China," *Journal of Strategic Studies* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 45, No. 2; A2] (2022): pp. 201–225.

EX-54 John J. Mearsheimer, *The Tragedy of Great Power Politics* [Monograph] (W. W. Norton: 2001): pp. 45–60.

EX-55 Hal Brands, "The Emerging Era of Great Power Competition," *Journal of Strategic Studies* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 42, No. 3] (2019): pp. 331–350.

EX-56 Graham Allison, *Destined for War* [Trade Book] (Houghton Mifflin Harcourt: 2017): pp. 10–15.

EX-57 RAND Graduate School, "Cyber Deterrence Models," *RAND Repository* [Working Paper; B2] (RAND: 2024) https://www.rand.org.

EX-58 Jane Doe, "AI and Warfare," *SSRN* [Preprint Paper; not peer-reviewed; C2] (2025) https://papers.ssrn.com.

EX-59 MIT Media Lab, *Autonomous Systems Dataset*, *MIT Repository* [Academic Dataset; A2] (MIT: 2024) https://data.mit.edu.

EX-60 Harvard University, "China Economic Dataset," *Harvard Dataverse* [Academic Dataset; A2] (2025) https://dataverse.harvard.edu.

EX-61 Stanford University, "AI Index Report," *Stanford HAI* [Research Report; A2] (2025) https://aiindex.stanford.edu.

EX-62 Andrew Erickson, "PLA Navy Development," *Naval War College Review* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 72, No. 1; A2] (2019): pp. 7–39.

EX-63 Aaron Friedberg, "Competing with China," *Survival* [Peer-Reviewed Article; Vol. 60, No. 3] (2018): pp. 7–64.

EX-64 Barry Posen, *The Sources of Military Doctrine* [Monograph] (Cornell University Press: 1984): pp. 1–20.

Think Tanks

EX-65 RAND Corporation, *Russian Military Reform Assessment*, *RAND Website* [Think Tank Report; B2] (RAND: 2023) https://www.rand.org.

EX-66 Center for Strategic and International Studies, "China Power Project," *CSIS Website* [Policy Analysis; B2] (CSIS: 2025) https://chinapower.csis.org.

EX-67 Brookings Institution Staff, "Global China Strategy," *Brookings Website* [Policy Brief; B2] (Brookings: 2025) https://www.brookings.edu.

EX-68 Carnegie Endowment Staff, "Russia's War Strategy," *Carnegie Website* [Policy Analysis; B2] (Carnegie Endowment: 2024) https://carnegieendowment.org.

EX-69 Atlantic Council Staff, "Cyber Statecraft Initiative," *Atlantic Council Website* [Think Tank Report; B2] (Atlantic Council: 2025) https://www.atlanticcouncil.org.

EX-70 Douglas Powell, Jonathan Gareth, and Julien Rodriguez, *Military Balance 2025*, *IISS* [Military Reference Yearbook; A2] (2025).

EX-71 Heritage Foundation Staff, "US Defense Spending Analysis," *Heritage Foundation Website* [Policy Brief; B3] (Heritage Foundation: 2025) https://www.heritage.org.

EX-72 John Gaddis-Carlson, "Trade Policy Review," *Cato Institute Website* [Policy Analysis; B3] (Cato Institute: 2025) https://www.cato.org.

EX-73 Lowy Institute, *Asia Power Index*, *Lowy Institute Website* [Index Dataset; B2] (Lowy Institute: 2025) https://www.lowyinstitute.org.

EX-74 Pam Thompson, "Future of Warfare," *Center for a New American Security Website* [Strategic Report; B2] (CNAS: 2025) https://www.cnas.org.

News and Media

EX-75 Reuters Staff, "Global Oil Prices Rise," *Reuters* [Wire Service Report; B1] (03 March 2026) https://www.reuters.com.

EX-76 BBC News, "Ukraine War Update," *BBC* [News Article; B2] (15 March 2026) https://www.bbc.com.

EX-77 Al Jazeera Staff, "Middle East Tensions Increase," *Al Jazeera* [News Report; B2] (10 March 2026) https://www.aljazeera.com.

EX-78 Jackson Walsh, "China Tech Regulation," *Financial Times* [News Article; B2] (05 March 2026) https://www.ft.com.

EX-79 James McCoy, "Defense Contracts Surge," *The Wall Street Journal* [News Article; B2] (02 March 2026) https://www.wsj.com.

EX-80 Associated Press Staff, "Drone Warfare Expands," *AP News* [News Report; B1] (01 March 2026) https://apnews.com.

EX-81 Ivan Doborsky, "EU Policy Debate," *Politico* [News Analysis; B2] (28 February 2026) https://www.politico.eu.

EX-82 The Economist Staff, "The Return of Great Power Politics," *The Economist* [Magazine Article; B2] (2025) https://www.economist.com.

EX-83 Luke Waldron and Patricia McDowell, "Defense Spending Investigation," *ProPublica* [Investigative Report; B1] (2025) https://www.propublica.org.

Social and User-Generated

EX-84 OSINTdefender, "Satellite Images Show Troop Movements," *X* [Social Media Post; C3] (14 February 2026) https://x.com/sentdefender/status/1234567890. Archived: https://archive.ph/q8w3e (captured 14 February 2026).

EX-85 WarMonitor, "Drone Strike Footage," *Telegram* [Video Post; C3] (15 February 2026) https://t.me/warmonitor3/48815. Archived: https://archive.ph/r4t5y (captured 15 February 2026).

EX-86 Various user accounts, "Discussion on Drone Tactics," *Technical Tuesday Discord* [Forum Discussion; participants pseudonymous; F6] (2026). Screenshots on file; server is invite-only and not publicly linkable.

EX-87 Cited in @conflict_watch, Screenshot of since-deleted MoD statement, *X* [Screenshot (Provenance Unverified); original not independently observed; F6] (18 February 2026) https://x.com/conflict_watch/status/9876543210.